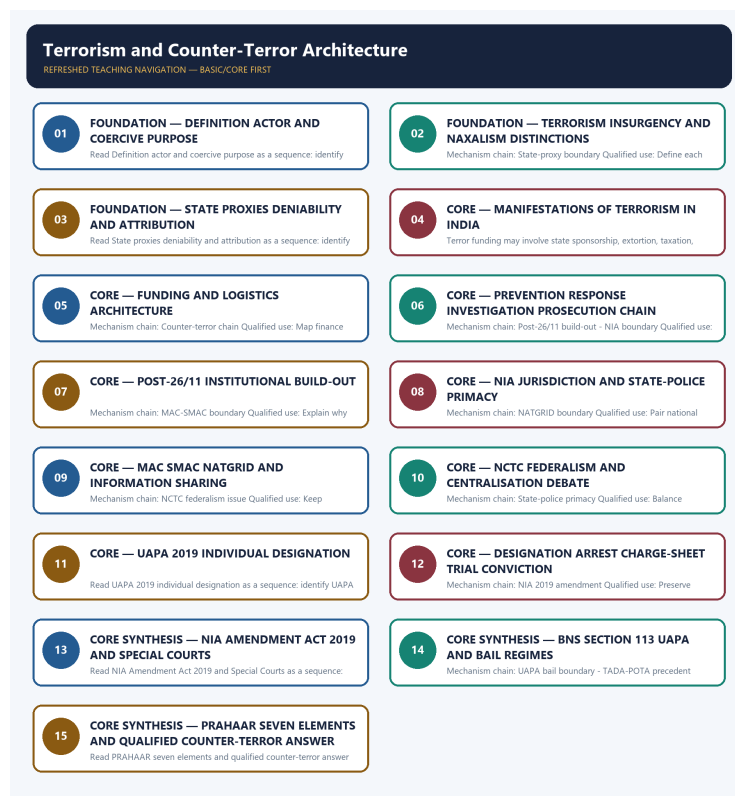


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture - Learner-v2

Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-04. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-04.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable official UPSC papers were supplementary only for printed routed demands. No answer key, attribution, operational method, notification effect, implementation outcome or security metric was inferred.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** The owner and audited GS-III ledgers route the 2019 UAPA/NIA amendment demand, the 2021 terrorism-complexity demand and the 2025 manifestation/counter-measures demand here. No objective key or unverified contemporary incident attribution is supplied.
- **Live-link boundary:** PRAHAAR is retained as MHA's 23 February 2026 policy and strategy with seven elements. Its release does not create a new agency or prove prevention, conviction, disruption or incident-reduction outcomes.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-04. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it supports; title-only, blocked or thin pages are recorded and supply no factual claim.

- <https://www.mha.gov.in/sites/default/files/NCTPolicyStrategy.pdf> - attempted 2026-09-04; the direct PDF fetch returned 403, while official-domain search and the owner support PRAHAAR's 23 February 2026 release and seven-element policy architecture. No budget, new agency, arrest power or measured outcome was inferred.
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/1513> - searched 2026-09-04; the official UAPA source supports the 2019 individual-designation framework and statutory review route. Designation is kept separate from arrest, charge-sheet and conviction.
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/1218/1/A2019-16.pdf> - searched 2026-09-04; the official NIA Amendment Act source supports extraterritorial scheduled-offence jurisdiction and Special Court changes. It supplies no case outcome or conviction claim.
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/> - searched 2026-09-04 for Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita section 113; the module preserves the owner-audited BNS-UAPA concurrency and SP-rank choice boundary without treating registration under either law as proof of guilt.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Internal Security Basic/Core is easy-first and answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Threat boundary	Actor, intent, capability, geography, target, harm and security-development nexus remain distinct.
Law/status boundary	Constitution, statute, rule, notification, guideline, advisory, designation, investigation, prosecution, conviction and measured outcome are not conflated.
Institutional boundary	Intelligence, police, NIA, prosecution, courts, CAPFs, armed forces, CERT-In, NCIIPC, I4C, Coast Guard and regulators retain exact mandates and federal limits.
Process boundary	Prevention, preparedness, response, investigation, prosecution, recovery and resilience are separate stages.
Current-data boundary	Every incident, casualty, budget, force, border, seizure, conviction, timeline and operational claim keeps source, date, unit, jurisdiction and status.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
PYQ contract	Official wording and keys are asserted only when verified; routed or reconstructed demands remain labelled.
Dual-flow contract	Graphical and ASCII masters independently reconstruct the same complete Basic-to-optional-Advanced evidence spine.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Internal-Security\basic\02_Terrorism-and-Counter-Terror-Architecture.md **Substantive canonical provenance owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Internal-Security\learning-sessions\v2\subject-wide-syllabus\internal-security-02_Learning-Session.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Internal-Security\advanced\02_Terrorism-and-Counter-Terror-Architecture.md **Official syllabus mapping:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Internal-Security\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- Law is separated from rules, notifications, guidelines and advisories; designation from conviction; investigation from prosecution.
- Intelligence is separated from admissible evidence; ceasefire/framework agreement from final settlement and implementation.
- Border guarding is separated from law and order; cyber incident from cybercrime; prevention from response; security output from development outcome.
- Every current Jammu and Kashmir, border, insurgency, terrorism, cyber, maritime, organised-crime, force or legal-status claim retains source/date/status.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-06:** failed official fetches remain explicit and supply no invented fact.

Generation-local live/current sources:

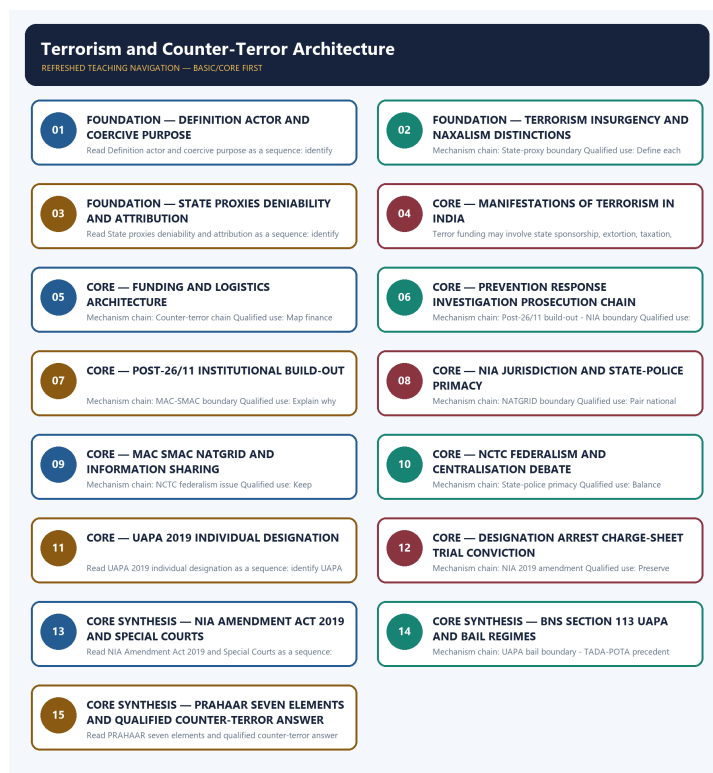
- <https://www.mha.gov.in/sites/default/files/NCTPolicyStrategy.pdf> - attempted 2026-09-04; the direct PDF fetch returned 403, while official-domain search and the owner support PRAHAAR's 23 February 2026 release and seven-element policy architecture. No budget, new agency, arrest power or measured outcome was inferred.
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/1513> - searched 2026-09-04; the official UAPA source supports the 2019 individual-designation framework and statutory review route. Designation is kept separate from arrest, charge-sheet and conviction.
- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/1218/1/A2019-16.pdf> - searched 2026-09-04; the official NIA Amendment Act source supports extraterritorial

scheduled-offence jurisdiction and Special Court changes. It supplies no case outcome or conviction claim.

- <https://www.indiacode.nic.in/> - searched 2026-09-04 for Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita section 113; the module preserves the owner-audited BNS-UAPA concurrency and SP-rank choice boundary without treating registration under either law as proof of guilt.

Topic-routed verified PYQ owners:

- Repository PYQ routing ledgers control wording, year, marks and verification status.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - DEFINITION ACTOR AND COERCIVE PURPOSE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.

Technical definition: Read Definition actor and coercive purpose as a sequence: identify Terrorism definition, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Definition actor and coercive purpose as a sequence: identify Terrorism definition, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Definition actor
- coercive purpose
- Mechanism chain

- **Qualified use**
- **Terrorism**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Definition actor, connect coercive purpose with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

DEFINITION ACTOR AND COERCIVE PURPOSE

01. Terrorism definition

|

v

02. Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Definition actor and coercive purpose as a sequence: identify Terrorism definition, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms. This keeps Terrorism definition and Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.
- Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Open with coercive purpose rather than an incident list.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Terrorism definition -> Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism
- **Qualified use:** Open with coercive purpose rather than an incident list.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - DEFINITION ACTOR AND COERCIVE PURPOSE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Definition actor and coercive purpose
|
v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Definition actor • coercive purpose • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Terrorism
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Terrorism definition - Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism
Qualified use: Open with coercive purpose rather than an incident list.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Definition actor and coercive purpose as a sequence: identify Terrorism definition, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - TERRORISM INSURGENCY AND NAXALISM DISTINCTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Terrorism insurgency and Naxalism distinctions as a sequence: identify State-proxy boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: State-proxy boundary Qualified use: Define each category before comparing its support base and objective.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Terrorism insurgency and Naxalism distinctions as a sequence: identify State-proxy boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- Terrorism insurgency
- Naxalism distinctions
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Read Terrorism

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Terrorism insurgency, connect Naxalism distinctions with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

TERRORISM INSURGENCY AND NAXALISM DISTINCTIONS

01. State-proxy boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly detached from possible state support.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Terrorism insurgency and Naxalism distinctions as a sequence: identify State-proxy boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly detached from possible state support. This keeps State-proxy boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly detached from possible state support.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Define each category before comparing its support base and objective.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** State-proxy boundary
- **Qualified use:** Define each category before comparing its support base and objective.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - TERRORISM INSURGENCY AND NAXALISM DISTINCTIONS

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - Terrorism insurgency and Naxalism distinctions

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • Terrorism insurgency • Naxalism distinctions • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Read Terrorism

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: State-proxy boundary Qualified use: Define each category before comparing its support base and objective.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly detached from possible state support.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Terrorism insurgency and Naxalism distinctions as a sequence: identify State-proxy boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - STATE PROXIES DENIABILITY AND ATTRIBUTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The decisive boundary is Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions.

Technical definition: Read State proxies deniability and attribution as a sequence: identify Manifestation categories, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read State proxies deniability and attribution as a sequence: identify Manifestation categories, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- attribution
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- India
- Jammu

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define attribution, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use India for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

STATE PROXIES DENIABILITY AND ATTRIBUTION

01. Manifestation categories

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read State proxies deniability and attribution as a sequence: identify Manifestation categories, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions. This keeps Manifestation categories in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Separate actor type, support relationship and attribution evidence.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Manifestation categories
- **Qualified use:** Separate actor type, support relationship and attribution evidence.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - STATE PROXIES DENIABILITY AND ATTRIBUTION

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - State proxies deniability and attribution
|
v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • attribution • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • India • Jammu
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Manifestation categories Qualified use: Separate actor type, support relationship and attribution evidence.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read State proxies deniability and attribution as a sequence: identify Manifestation categories, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 4 - CORE - MANIFESTATIONS OF TERRORISM IN INDIA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Manifestations of terrorism in India as a sequence: identify Funding architecture, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Manifestations of terrorism in India as a sequence: identify Funding architecture, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Manifestations of terrorism in India**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Terror**
- **Topic**
- **Read Manifestations**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Manifestations of terrorism in India; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with Terror to explain the mechanism, and use Topic for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MANIFESTATIONS OF TERRORISM IN INDIA

01. Funding architecture

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not merge NIA, MAC, NATGRID, NCTC and NSG.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Manifestations of terrorism in India as a sequence: identify Funding architecture, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not merge NIA, MAC, NATGRID, NCTC and NSG. This keeps Funding architecture in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge NIA, MAC, NATGRID, NCTC and NSG.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Use analytical categories and only safely dated examples.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Funding architecture
- **Qualified use:** Use analytical categories and only safely dated examples.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - MANIFESTATIONS OF TERRORISM IN INDIA

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Manifestations of terrorism in India

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Manifestations of terrorism in India • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Terror • Topic • Read Manifestations

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Funding architecture Qualified use: Use analytical categories and only safely dated examples.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not merge NIA, MAC, NATGRID, NCTC and NSG.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not merge NIA, MAC, NATGRID, NCTC and NSG.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Manifestations of terrorism in India as a sequence: identify Funding architecture, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 5 - CORE - FUNDING AND LOGISTICS ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Funding and logistics architecture as a sequence: identify Counter-terror chain, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Counter-terror chain Qualified use: Map finance channels without drifting into unverified transaction detail.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Funding and logistics architecture as a sequence: identify Counter-terror chain, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Funding
- logistics architecture
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- NIA
- Read Funding

How to use them: Frame the answer through Funding; define logistics architecture, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use NIA for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

FUNDING AND LOGISTICS ARCHITECTURE

01. Counter-terror chain

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not describe intelligence sharing as admissible proof.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Funding and logistics architecture as a sequence: identify Counter-terror chain, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not describe intelligence sharing as admissible proof. This keeps Counter-terror chain in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not describe intelligence sharing as admissible proof.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Map finance channels without drifting into unverified transaction detail.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Counter-terror chain
- **Qualified use:** Map finance channels without drifting into unverified transaction detail.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - FUNDING AND LOGISTICS ARCHITECTURE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Funding and logistics architecture

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Funding · logistics architecture · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · NIA · Read Funding

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Counter-terror chain Qualified use: Map finance channels without drifting into unverified transaction detail.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not describe intelligence sharing as admissible proof.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not describe intelligence sharing as admissible proof.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Funding and logistics architecture as a sequence: identify Counter-terror chain, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 6 - CORE - PREVENTION RESPONSE INVESTIGATION PROSECUTION CHAIN

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Prevention response investigation prosecution chain as a sequence: identify Post-26/11 build-out, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: Post-26/11 build-out - NIA boundary Qualified use: Assign each function to its competent institution.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Prevention response investigation prosecution chain as a sequence: identify Post-26/11 build-out, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Prevention response investigation prosecution chain**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **After**
- **Mumbai**
- **NIA**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Prevention response investigation prosecution chain; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with After to explain the mechanism, and use Mumbai for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PREVENTION RESPONSE INVESTIGATION PROSECUTION CHAIN

01. Post-26/11 build-out

|

v

02. NIA boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not describe NIA as a replacement for State police.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Prevention response investigation prosecution chain as a sequence: identify Post-26/11 build-out, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not describe NIA as a replacement for State police. This keeps Post-26/11 build-out and NIA boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.
- The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not describe NIA as a replacement for State police.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Assign each function to its competent institution.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Post-26/11 build-out -> NIA boundary
- **Qualified use:** Assign each function to its competent institution.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - PREVENTION RESPONSE INVESTIGATION PROSECUTION CHAIN

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Prevention response investigation prosecution chain

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Prevention response investigation prosecution chain • Mechanism chain • Qualified use

• After • Mumbai • NIA

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: Post-26/11 build-out - NIA boundary Qualified use: Assign each function to its competent institution.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not describe NIA as a replacement for State police.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Prevention response investigation prosecution chain as a sequence: identify Post-26/11 build-out, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 7 - CORE - POST-26/11 INSTITUTIONAL BUILD-OUT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Post-26/11 institutional build-out as a sequence: identify MAC-SMAC boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: MAC-SMAC boundary Qualified use: Explain why institutional multiplication requires coordination.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mechanism chain: MAC-SMAC boundary Qualified use: Explain why institutional multiplication requires coordination.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Post-26/11 institutional build-out
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- MAC and SMAC
- MAC
- SMAC

How to use them: Frame the answer through Post-26/11 institutional build-out; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with MAC and SMAC to explain the mechanism, and use MAC for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

POST-26/11 INSTITUTIONAL BUILD-OUT

01. MAC-SMAC boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not call individual designation a conviction.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Post-26/11 institutional build-out as a sequence: identify MAC-SMAC boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not call individual designation a conviction. This keeps MAC-SMAC boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not call individual designation a conviction.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Explain why institutional multiplication requires coordination.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** MAC-SMAC boundary
- **Qualified use:** Explain why institutional multiplication requires coordination.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - POST-26/11 INSTITUTIONAL BUILD-OUT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Post-26/11 institutional build-out

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Post-26/11 institutional build-out · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · MAC and SMAC · MAC · SMAC

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Read Post-26/11 institutional build-out as a sequence: identify MAC-SMAC boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not call individual designation a conviction.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mechanism chain: MAC-SMAC boundary Qualified use: Explain why institutional multiplication requires coordination.

SESSION 8 - CORE - NIA JURISDICTION AND STATE-POLICE PRIMACY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read NIA jurisdiction and State-police primacy as a sequence: identify NATGRID boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: NATGRID boundary Qualified use: Pair national jurisdiction with local first-response capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read NIA jurisdiction and State-police primacy as a sequence: identify NATGRID boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- NIA jurisdiction
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- NATGRID
- Read NIA
- The decisive boundary

How to use them: Frame the answer through NIA jurisdiction; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with NATGRID to explain the mechanism, and use Read NIA for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NIA JURISDICTION AND STATE-POLICE PRIMACY

01. NATGRID boundary

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not say BNS section 113 repealed UAPA.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read NIA jurisdiction and State-police primacy as a sequence: identify NATGRID boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not say BNS section 113 repealed UAPA. This keeps NATGRID boundary in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not say BNS section 113 repealed UAPA.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Pair national jurisdiction with local first-response capacity.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** NATGRID boundary
- **Qualified use:** Pair national jurisdiction with local first-response capacity.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - NIA JURISDICTION AND STATE-POLICE PRIMACY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - NIA jurisdiction and State-police primacy

|

v

EXACT TERMS: NIA jurisdiction • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • NATGRID • Read NIA • The decisive boundary

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: NATGRID boundary Qualified use: Pair national jurisdiction with local first-response capacity.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not say BNS section 113 repealed UAPA.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read NIA jurisdiction and State-police primacy as a sequence: identify NATGRID boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 9 - CORE - MAC SMAC NATGRID AND INFORMATION SHARING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read MAC SMAC NATGRID and information sharing as a sequence: identify NCTC federalism issue, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: NCTC federalism issue Qualified use: Keep information platforms outside arrest and prosecution functions.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read MAC SMAC NATGRID and information sharing as a sequence: identify NCTC federalism issue, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **MAC SMAC NATGRID**
- **information sharing**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **NCTC**
- **Read MAC SMAC NATGRID**

How to use them: Frame the answer through MAC SMAC NATGRID; define information sharing, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use NCTC for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

MAC SMAC NATGRID AND INFORMATION SHARING

01. NCTC federalism issue

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not convert statutory reach into investigative throughput.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read MAC SMAC NATGRID and information sharing as a sequence: identify NCTC federalism issue, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not convert statutory reach into investigative throughput. This keeps NCTC federalism issue in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not convert statutory reach into investigative throughput.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Keep information platforms outside arrest and prosecution functions.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** NCTC federalism issue
- **Qualified use:** Keep information platforms outside arrest and prosecution functions.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - MAC SMAC NATGRID AND INFORMATION SHARING

START / CONCEPT: CORE - MAC SMAC NATGRID and information sharing

|

v

EXACT TERMS: MAC SMAC NATGRID • information sharing • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • NCTC • Read
MAC SMAC NATGRID

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: NCTC federalism issue Qualified use: Keep information
platforms outside arrest and prosecution functions.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and
investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the
coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not convert statutory reach into investigative
throughput.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read MAC SMAC NATGRID and information sharing as a sequence: identify
NCTC federalism issue, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the
last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 10 - CORE - NCTC FEDERALISM AND CENTRALISATION DEBATE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read NCTC federalism and centralisation debate as a sequence: identify State-police primacy, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: State-police primacy Qualified use: Balance coordination needs against federal and institutional safeguards.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read NCTC federalism and centralisation debate as a sequence: identify State-police primacy, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- NCTC federalism
- centralisation debate
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Read NCTC
- The decisive boundary

How to use them: Frame the answer through NCTC federalism; define centralisation debate, connect Mechanism chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Read NCTC for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NCTC FEDERALISM AND CENTRALISATION DEBATE

01. State-police primacy

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not omit bail and review safeguards from a legal-power answer.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read NCTC federalism and centralisation debate as a sequence: identify State-police primacy, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not omit bail and review safeguards from a legal-power answer. This keeps State-police primacy in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not omit bail and review safeguards from a legal-power answer.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Balance coordination needs against federal and institutional safeguards.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** State-police primacy
- **Qualified use:** Balance coordination needs against federal and institutional safeguards.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - NCTC FEDERALISM AND CENTRALISATION DEBATE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - NCTC federalism and centralisation debate

|

v

EXACT TERMS: NCTC federalism • centralisation debate • Mechanism chain • Qualified use • Read NCTC
• The decisive boundary

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: State-police primacy Qualified use: Balance coordination needs against federal and institutional safeguards.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not omit bail and review safeguards from a legal-power answer.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not omit bail and review safeguards from a legal-power answer.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read NCTC federalism and centralisation debate as a sequence: identify State-police primacy, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 11 - CORE - UAPA 2019 INDIVIDUAL DESIGNATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

Technical definition: Read UAPA 2019 individual designation as a sequence: identify UAPA 2019 designation, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **UAPA 2019 individual designation**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction**
- **Individual**
- **Read UAPA**

How to use them: Frame the answer through UAPA 2019 individual designation; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction to explain the mechanism, and use Individual for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

UAPA 2019 INDIVIDUAL DESIGNATION

01. UAPA 2019 designation

|
v

02. Designation-conviction firewall

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not describe PRAHAAR as a new operational agency.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read UAPA 2019 individual designation as a sequence: identify UAPA 2019 designation, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not describe PRAHAAR as a new operational agency. This keeps UAPA 2019 designation and Designation-conviction firewall in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.
- Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not describe PRAHAAR as a new operational agency.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** State the security rationale and the executive-notification safeguard.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** UAPA 2019 designation -> Designation-conviction firewall
- **Qualified use:** State the security rationale and the executive-notification safeguard.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - UAPA 2019 INDIVIDUAL DESIGNATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - UAPA 2019 individual designation

|

v

EXACT TERMS: UAPA 2019 individual designation · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction · Individual · Read UAPA

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Read UAPA 2019 individual designation as a sequence: identify UAPA 2019 designation, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mechanism chain: UAPA 2019 designation - Designation-conviction firewall
Qualified use: State the security rationale and the executive-notification safeguard.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not describe PRAHAAR as a new operational agency.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

SESSION 12 - CORE - DESIGNATION ARREST CHARGE-SHEET TRIAL CONVICTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read Designation arrest charge-sheet trial conviction as a sequence: identify NIA 2019 amendment, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: NIA 2019 amendment
Qualified use: Preserve every evidentiary rung explicitly.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read Designation arrest charge-sheet trial conviction as a sequence: identify NIA 2019 amendment, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Designation arrest charge-sheet trial conviction
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Read Designation
- NIA
- The decisive boundary

How to use them: Frame the answer through Designation arrest charge-sheet trial conviction; define Mechanism chain, connect Qualified use with Read Designation to explain the mechanism, and use NIA for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

DESIGNATION ARREST CHARGE-SHEET TRIAL CONVICTION

01. NIA 2019 amendment

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not expose tactical details, identities or unverified incident claims.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read Designation arrest charge-sheet trial conviction as a sequence: identify NIA 2019 amendment, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not expose tactical details, identities or unverified incident claims. This keeps NIA 2019 amendment in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not expose tactical details, identities or unverified incident claims.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Preserve every evidentiary rung explicitly.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** NIA 2019 amendment
- **Qualified use:** Preserve every evidentiary rung explicitly.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - DESIGNATION ARREST CHARGE-SHEET TRIAL CONVICTION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Designation arrest charge-sheet trial conviction

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Designation arrest charge-sheet trial conviction · Mechanism chain · Qualified use ·
Read Designation · NIA · The decisive boundary

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: NIA 2019 amendment Qualified use: Preserve every evidentiary
rung explicitly.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The decisive boundary is Do not expose tactical details, identities or
unverified incident claims.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not expose tactical details, identities or unverified incident claims.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read Designation arrest charge-sheet trial conviction as a sequence:
identify NIA 2019 amendment, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at
the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - NIA AMENDMENT ACT 2019 AND SPECIAL COURTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Technical definition: Read NIA Amendment Act 2019 and Special Courts as a sequence: identify BNS-UAPA concurrency, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read NIA Amendment Act 2019 and Special Courts as a sequence: identify BNS-UAPA concurrency, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- NIA Amendment Act 2019
- Special Courts
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE Read NIA Amendment Act 2019

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define NIA Amendment Act 2019, connect Special Courts with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

NIA AMENDMENT ACT 2019 AND SPECIAL COURTS

01. BNS-UAPA concurrency

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read NIA Amendment Act 2019 and Special Courts as a sequence: identify BNS-UAPA concurrency, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms. This keeps BNS-UAPA concurrency in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Name the amendment's jurisdictional changes without claiming outcomes.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** BNS-UAPA concurrency
- **Qualified use:** Name the amendment's jurisdictional changes without claiming outcomes.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - NIA AMENDMENT ACT 2019 AND SPECIAL COURTS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - NIA Amendment Act 2019 and Special Courts

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · NIA Amendment Act 2019 · Special Courts · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE Read NIA Amendment Act 2019

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: BNS-UAPA concurrency Qualified use: Name the amendment's jurisdictional changes without claiming outcomes.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read NIA Amendment Act 2019 and Special Courts as a sequence: identify BNS-UAPA concurrency, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - BNS SECTION 113 UAPA AND BAIL REGIMES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Read BNS section 113 UAPA and bail regimes as a sequence: identify UAPA bail boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

Technical definition: Mechanism chain: UAPA bail boundary - TADA-POTA precedent Qualified use: Compare legal routes, bail and sanction without treating registration as guilt.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read BNS section 113 UAPA and bail regimes as a sequence: identify UAPA bail boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **BNS section 113 UAPA**
- **bail regimes**
- **Mechanism chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **UAPA**

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define BNS section 113 UAPA, connect bail regimes with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or

qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

BNS SECTION 113 UAPA AND BAIL REGIMES

01. UAPA bail boundary

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v

02. TADA-POTA precedent

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly detached from possible state support.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read BNS section 113 UAPA and bail regimes as a sequence: identify UAPA bail boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly detached from possible state support. This keeps UAPA bail boundary and TADA-POTA precedent in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
- TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly detached from possible state support.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Compare legal routes, bail and sanction without treating registration as guilt.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** UAPA bail boundary -> TADA-POTA precedent
- **Qualified use:** Compare legal routes, bail and sanction without treating registration as guilt.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - BNS SECTION 113 UAPA AND BAIL REGIMES

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - BNS section 113 UAPA and bail regimes

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS • BNS section 113 UAPA • bail regimes • Mechanism chain • Qualified use
• UAPA

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: UAPA bail boundary - TADA-POTA precedent Qualified use:
Compare legal routes, bail and sanction without treating registration as guilt.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold;
pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The decisive boundary is Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly
detached from possible state support.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read BNS section 113 UAPA and bail regimes as a sequence: identify
UAPA bail boundary, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last
verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - PRAHAAR SEVEN ELEMENTS AND QUALIFIED COUNTER-TERROR ANSWER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: CURRENT: MHA's PRAHAAR (23 February 2026) is India's first comprehensive national counter-terrorism policy and strategy, organised around seven elements (prevention, response, aggregating capacities, human rights/rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, recovery/resilience) and explicitly recognises newer threat domains - cyberattacks, drone-based attacks and dark web/cryptocurrency misuse - without creating a new standalone agency; it works through existing coordination mechanisms (MAC, NIA).

Technical definition: Read PRAHAAR seven elements and qualified counter-terror answer as a sequence: identify PRAHAAR policy, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Read PRAHAAR seven elements and qualified counter-terror answer as a sequence: identify PRAHAAR policy, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- PRAHAAR seven elements
- qualified counter-terror answer
- Mechanism chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define PRAHAAR seven elements, connect qualified counter-terror answer with Mechanism chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

PRAHAAR SEVEN ELEMENTS AND QUALIFIED COUNTER-TERROR ANSWER

01. PRAHAAR policy

|
v

02. Policy-agency-outcome firewall

STATUS / CATEGORY FIREWALL -> Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions.

The rail fixes the institutional sequence and claim boundary before explanation.

CORE EXPLANATION

PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

SIMPLE SYSTEM EXAMPLE

Read PRAHAAR seven elements and qualified counter-terror answer as a sequence: identify PRAHAAR policy, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

TECHNICAL DISTINCTION

The decisive boundary is Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions. This keeps PRAHAAR policy and Policy-agency-outcome firewall in the correct legal category, institutional mandate and evidentiary status.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.
- PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Keep institution, law, notification, ban/listing, scheme, agreement, ceasefire and outcome in their exact category.
- **Mains:** Use the seven elements as a policy frame and finish with rule-of-law legitimacy.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** PRAHAAR policy -> Policy-agency-outcome firewall
- **Qualified use:** Use the seven elements as a policy frame and finish with rule-of-law legitimacy.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Internal Security | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III. **Core area:** Definition of terrorism; state vs. non-state actors; categories of terrorism in India; funding sources; the UAPA/NIA/NCTC/ NATGRID institutional response; the 2019 UAPA and NIA amendments and BNS Section 113; the 2026 PRAHAAR policy. **Grounded in:** Ashok Kumar Singh, *Challenges to Internal Security of India*, PDF pp. 7-22; VisionIAS, *Challenges to Internal Security through Communication Network*, PDF pp. 23, 27; 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 1, 5-6; audited GS-III syllabus; MHA, *National Counter-Terrorism Policy and Strategy - PRAHAAR* (23 February 2026); UAPA (Amendment) Act 2019, NIA (Amendment) Act 2019 and BNS 2023 as published in India Code. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor | **WRONG:** = boundary/trap. *Companion:* advanced/02_Terrorism-and-Counter-Terror-Architecture.md.

1. Visual foundation

DEFINITION

planned, organised, systematic use of violence for political/religious/ideological coercion (Singh, PDF p. 7)

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v

ACTOR TYPE

external state actor | non-state actor
(often a state proxy with deniability)

|
v

CATEGORY IN INDIA

hinterland terrorism | J&K militancy |
North-East insurgency | Left-Wing Extremism

|
v

FUNDING

state sponsorship | extortion/taxation |
FICN | hawala | organised-crime linkage

|
v

RESPONSE CHAIN

prevention (intelligence) -> containment
(police/forces) -> investigation (NIA/state
police) -> prosecution (special courts)

|
v

CURRENT POLICY FRAME

PRAHAAR (2026): prevention, response,
aggregating capacities, human rights,
attenuating conditions, international
efforts, recovery/resilience

Core proposition: FACT: Singh defines terrorism as "the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as a means of coercion for political or religious or ideological purposes," noting that no internationally agreed definition exists because "a 'terrorist' in one country may be viewed as a 'freedom fighter' in another" (PDF p. 7).

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Terrorism (working definition)	Planned, organised, systematic use of violence for political/religious/ideological coercion (Singh, PDF p. 7).
FACT: External state actor	A government directly or indirectly indulging in terrorism against its own people or another country; Singh cites "terrorism in Kashmir" as "a direct manifestation of state policy of Pakistan and ISI influence" (PDF p. 8).
FACT: Non-state actor	An individual or group acting without direct government association; Singh notes groups like LeT and Indian Mujahideen "claim to be non-state actors but have de facto support from Pakistan" - the "proxy" concept (PDF p. 8).
FACT: Categories of terrorism in India	Hinterland terrorism; J&K militancy; North-East insurgency; Left-Wing Extremism (Singh, PDF p. 9) - this folder treats the latter three as dedicated topics (03, 04, 05).
FACT: Sleeper cell	A dormant agent or cell placed in a target country/organisation, activated only on order (Singh, PDF p. 12).
FACT: UAPA (Unlawful Activities Prevention) Act	India's principal anti-terrorism statute, enacted 1967 and amended in 1969, 1972, 1986, 2004, 2008, 2012 (Singh, PDF p. 17) and - after Singh's book-period - 2019 . The 2019 amendment allows the Central Government to designate an individual (not only an organisation) as a terrorist under the Fourth Schedule, permits investigation by an NIA officer of the rank of Inspector or above , and requires the Director General, NIA to approve seizure/attachment of property in NIA-investigated cases (instead of the State DGP).
FACT: Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023	In force 1 July 2024, replacing the Indian Penal Code. For the first time, general penal law itself defines a "terrorist act" (Section 113) and organised crime (Section 111) ; UAPA continues as the special law, and BNS Section 113 provides that an officer not below the rank of Superintendent of Police decides whether a case is registered under BNS or under UAPA. The BNSS (procedure) and BSA (evidence) replaced the CrPC and the Evidence Act on the same date.

3. How the counter-terror mechanism works

- 1. Actor and proxy logic:** FACT: Singh explains Pakistan's use of non-state actors as "essentially the employment of a proxy element, which gives the state of Pakistan a degree of deniability," while noting "none of the so called 'non-state actors', like the LeT, could have operated with impunity without active funding, logistical and military support from Pakistan" (PDF p. 8).
- 2. Funding:** FACT: J&K militancy is described as "a classical case of state-sponsored and financed terrorism," with ISI employing "state and private resources, like money from drugs and contraband, donations and charities" plus "funding from the Kashmiri diaspora and NGOs" (PDF p. 13). ANALYSIS: Other categories (hinterland, North-East, LWE) draw more heavily on domestic extortion, taxation and smuggling - developed in topics 03-04 and 11.
- 3. Institutional response after 26/11:** FACT: The 2008 Mumbai attacks triggered creation/strengthening of NIA, NATGRID, MAC (revamped) and NCTC (proposed), plus four new NSG hubs and a revamped Coastal Security Scheme (Singh, PDF pp. 15-16).
- 4. Legal framework evolution:** FACT: TADA (in force 1985-1995; Singh notes it was "the first anti-terrorism law legislated by the government to define and counter terrorist activities," allowed to lapse in 1995 "due to widespread allegations of abuse") -> POTA (2002, enacted after the December 2001 Parliament attack; repealed 2004) -> UAPA amendments of 2004, 2008 and 2012 (Singh, PDF pp. 16-17) -> ANALYSIS: **UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019** and **NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019**, both after Singh's book-period -> **BNS/BNSS/BSA, 2023**

in force 1 July 2024, which brought terrorism and organised crime into the general penal code for the first time.

ANALYSIS: Note the recurring pattern the examiner rewards: each special law widened investigative power *and* was later criticised on due-process grounds - TADA and POTA on confession-admissibility and prolonged pre-charge detention, UAPA on bail and on designating individuals.

5. **Current policy frame:** CURRENT: The MHA's *PRAHAAR* policy (23 February 2026). is India's first comprehensive national counter-terrorism policy

document, organised around prevention, response, aggregating capacities, human-rights-based process, attenuating radicalisation conditions, aligning international efforts, and whole-of-society recovery/resilience - it formalises coordination through existing bodies (MAC, NIA) rather than creating a new agency.

6. ****Prevention is not response - and the two are measured**

differently:** ANALYSIS: Prevention (intelligence, de-radicalisation, community engagement, vulnerability reduction) produces an *absence* of incidents and is therefore hard to evidence; response (NSG hubs, interdiction, arrests) produces countable outputs. PRAHAAR's "attenuating conditions" element is the prevention half; its "response" and "aggregating capacities" elements are the response half. A Mains answer that names both halves, and notes the measurement asymmetry between them, out-performs one that lists agencies.

4. Institutions, laws and reference points

- FACT: **National Investigation Agency (NIA):** created by the NIA Act, 2008,

with concurrent jurisdiction to probe terror-related offences anywhere in India (Singh, PDF p. 15). Its schedule already covered, at enactment, offences against sovereignty and integrity, bomb blasts, hijacking of aircraft and ships, attacks on nuclear installations, counterfeit currency, human trafficking, narcotics, organised-crime mobs and gangs, and Atomic Energy/WMD Act violations (Singh, PDF p. 18). ANALYSIS: The **NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019** - after Singh's book-period - extended NIA's reach to **scheduled offences committed outside India** against Indian citizens or Indian interests, added further scheduled offences (including human trafficking, counterfeit currency, manufacture or sale of prohibited arms, cyber terrorism and offences under the Explosive Substances Act, 1908), and empowered the Central Government to designate **Sessions Courts** as Special Courts.

- FACT: **Special NIA Courts:** notified under Sections 11 and 22 of the NIA

Act, presided over by a judge appointed on the recommendation of the Chief Justice of the relevant High Court, vested with all powers of a Court of Session, required to hold day-to-day trials with precedence over other cases, with appeal to the High Court; States may also appoint Special Courts (Singh, PDF p. 18). ANALYSIS: Singh's count of Special NIA Courts is book-period - verify the current number from NIA/MHA.

- ANALYSIS: **NATGRID:** an intelligence-sharing grid linking multiple agency

databases, proposed after 26/11. Singh's book states it "is yet to become operational" (PDF p. 15) - a book-period claim. ANALYSIS: VisionIAS's 2024 update describes NATGRID in present operational terms, as "an integrated intelligence master database structure that links databases from several security agencies within the Government of India" and makes them "easily accessible to security agencies around the clock" (*Communication Network*, PDF p. 27); treat that as a 2024 secondary description and confirm current status/coverage from the MHA Annual Report 2024-25 before citing detail.

- FACT: **National Counter Terrorism Centre (NCTC):** conceived post-26/11 as

a single apex counter-terror body under IB's administrative control, but faced criticism for infringing States' policing powers under the constitutional scheme; Singh notes the concept remained contested (PDF pp. 17-18). FACT: A second, less-quoted objection in the same passage is institutional rather than federal: granting arrest powers to an intelligence body violates "the principle of not granting the power of arrest to intelligence agencies" (PDF p. 18).

- FACT: **Four new NSG hubs:** created post-26/11 at Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai

and Hyderabad, in addition to Manesar, "to ensure faster and more effective reaction to crisis situations" (Singh, PDF p. 16) - a *response* (not prevention) capability measure.

- FACT: **UAPA:** widened in 2012 to include economic offences (fund-raising, counterfeiting) within "terrorist act"; widened again in 2019 to permit designation of individuals as terrorists.

- CURRENT: **PRAHAAR (23 February 2026):** MHA's first comprehensive national

counter-terrorism policy and strategy document.

- CURRENT: **UNSC Counter-Terrorism Committee's Delhi Declaration (2022)**: on

countering the use of new and emerging technologies for terrorist purposes, adopted at the special CTC meeting hosted by India - cited by VisionIAS among "measures taken to address the misuse of technology by extremists," alongside the Global Counterterrorism Forum's Berlin Memorandum on countering terrorist use of unmanned aerial systems and FATF's 2018 virtual-asset guidance (*Communication Network*, PDF p. 23). ANALYSIS: IR owns the diplomatic negotiation of these instruments; this folder claims their domestic operational effect.

5. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: Singh's list of "important terrorist attacks" (1993 Mumbai to 2014

Patna) is a book-period historical chronology (PDF pp. 10-11); do not cite it as a current or complete list, and do not present alleged group/ individual involvement as adjudicated fact.

- FACT: Singh distinguishes terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism precisely:

terrorism is the general category; insurgency is "an act of rebellion and armed struggle... with public support for the insurgents"; Naxalism is the use of violence "to destabilise the state through communist guerrilla warfare" (PDF p. 22).

- CURRENT: **PYQ mapping - verbatim (2025 Q9)**: "Terrorism is a global scourge.

How has it manifested in India? Elaborate with contemporary examples. What are the counter measures adopted by the State? Explain." - use PRAHAAR (2026) for current counter-measure language, and verify any "contemporary example" separately from an official release before citing it as fact.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: TADA was in force 1985-1995; POTA, 2002-2004; both were repealed amid misuse concerns.

- FACT: UAPA was enacted in 1967 and amended in 1969, 1972, 1986, 2004, 2008 and 2012; ANALYSIS: the **2019 amendment** (post-dating this book) added designation of **individuals** as terrorists, Inspector-rank NIA investigation, and DG NIA approval for property attachment in NIA-investigated cases.

- FACT: NIA was created by the NIA Act, 2008, following the 26/11 Mumbai attacks; the **NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019** extended its jurisdiction to scheduled offences committed outside India against Indian citizens or Indian interests and allowed Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

- FACT: The **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023** (in force 1 July 2024) defines a terrorist act in **Section 113** and organised crime in **Section 111** - the first time either appears in India's general penal code; UAPA remains the special law and an officer not below SP rank decides which statute a case is registered under.

- FACT: Four new NSG hubs were created after 26/11 at Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai and Hyderabad, in addition to Manesar.

- CURRENT: PRAHAAR, MHA's first comprehensive national counter-terrorism policy and strategy document, was released on 23 February 2026.

- FACT: Singh's three-part difference: terrorism (general category), insurgency (public-supported armed rebellion), Naxalism (Maoist-inspired guerrilla warfare to capture state power).

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: NATGRID, NCTC and NIA are functionally the same body. -> NIA is a central investigating agency; NATGRID is a data-sharing intelligence tool; NCTC was a proposed apex coordinating body that remained contested and was never fully implemented as originally conceived - keep the three institutionally distinct (developed further in topic 12).

- WRONG: UAPA's amendment history ends in 2012. -> That is where Singh's book-period account ends; the **2019 amendment** is the one most likely to be tested, because it introduced individual designation.

- WRONG: Designation of an individual as a terrorist under UAPA is a judicial finding of guilt. -> It is an **executive** notification by the Central Government under the Fourth Schedule, reviewable through the statutory denotification/review process; it is neither a charge nor a conviction - keep designation, arrest, charge-sheet and conviction as four distinct evidentiary levels.

- WRONG: Because BNS now defines a terrorist act, UAPA has been repealed. ->

Both are in force; BNS Section 113 is general penal law, UAPA is the special law with its own designation, forfeiture and bail regime.

- WRONG: Every non-state actor group is wholly independent of any state. ->

Singh's proxy-war framing shows several "non-state" groups received de facto state support while retaining official deniability for the sponsor state.

- WRONG: TADA and POTA are still in force. -> Both were allowed to lapse/were repealed; current terrorism prosecutions rely on the UAPA, the NIA Act framework and, since 1 July 2024, BNS Section 113.

- WRONG: All named historical attacks and group leadership details in Singh's book remain the current status of those organisations. -> These are book-period facts; verify any current claim about a specific group from a dated official source.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: MHA's **PRAHAAR** (23 February 2026) is India's first comprehensive national counter-terrorism policy and strategy, organised around seven elements (prevention, response, aggregating capacities, human rights/rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, recovery/resilience) and explicitly recognises newer threat domains - cyberattacks, drone-based attacks and dark web/cryptocurrency misuse - without creating a new standalone agency; it works through existing coordination mechanisms (MAC, NIA).

Current manifestation card - use status verbs precisely

- CURRENT: The **2025 Pahalgam terror-attack case** is a safe contemporary manifestation example only at the level stated by the NIA: MHA transferred the investigation to NIA, and NIA's later case material/ chargesheets describe an alleged Pakistan-linked conspiracy and local facilitation. In an answer, write **"NIA is investigating/has chargesheeted"**, not "proved/convicted"; do not add casualty figures, identities or an attribution beyond the dated NIA record.

- CURRENT: NIA's 2025 Jammu/Kashmir module searches likewise illustrate investigation of alleged infiltration, logistical facilitation and drone/arms-delivery channels. Searches, seizures and charges are disruption/investigation stages, not a judicial finding.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Do not answer "how has terrorism manifested in India" with only a chronology of past attacks - use Singh's four-category framework (hinterland/J&K/North-East/LWE) to organise the answer analytically.

- ANALYSIS: For "counter measures," structure the response along the prevention-response-investigation-prosecution chain (Section 1), citing the specific institution at each stage (IB/state police for prevention; CAPFs/NSG for response; NIA/state police for investigation; special NIA courts for prosecution), then anchor the whole in PRAHAAR (2026).

- ANALYSIS: ****Name the legal instrument precisely, and at the right evidentiary level.**** UAPA (with the 2019 amendment), the NIA Act (with the 2019 amendment) and BNS Section 113 are three distinct hooks; designation, arrest, charge-sheet and conviction are four distinct outcomes. An answer that says "strict laws have been enacted" earns less than one that names the section and then notes, separately, that statutory power is not the same as prosecutorial throughput.

- ANALYSIS: Where a question invites "state versus non-state actor" analysis, use the proxy-war/deniability framing (Section 3) rather than treating the categories as mutually exclusive.

- ANALYSIS: For "contemporary examples," prefer dated institutional or policy developments you can source (PRAHAAR 2026; the 2019 amendments; the UNSC CTC Delhi Declaration on emerging technologies) over incident claims you cannot verify - the question rewards currency, not casualty figures.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** In which year was the NIA Act enacted, and what is the nature of NIA's jurisdiction?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Distinguish terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as used in India's internal-security discourse.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "Non-state actors are frequently proxies for state sponsors seeking deniability." Discuss with reference to terrorism in India.

12. Core answer architecture - manifestations, law and calibrated counter-terrorism

Core firewall: The following evidence bank and spines independently support the 2019/2021/2025 terrorism demands. Advanced material is optional depth, not a condition for a marks-worthy answer.

Demand decoder and thesis

Thesis: Terrorism in India is not one incident category but a set of political/ideological coercion pathways; a credible counter-terror answer matches prevention, response, investigation, prosecution, finance disruption and recovery to the pathway while preserving lawful process. "Contemporary" requires a dated policy or officially verified event - not an uncited casualty figure or an asserted attribution.

Executable Core spines

10 marks - 2025 manifestation and measures. Define terrorism in one line; organise manifestations by **hinterland/module, J&K proxy, North-East insurgency and LWE-linked violence**, with one named, safely dated institutional or case-status example for each relevant point rather than a chronology of attacks. The NIA-documented 2025 Pahalgam case can anchor the J&K leg if its investigation/chargesheet status is stated precisely. Map State measures as prevention/community resilience -> MAC/IB information sharing -> police/CAPF/NSG containment -> NIA or State-police investigation -> Special Court prosecution -> finance disruption. Use PRAHAAR (MHA, 23 February 2026) as the policy umbrella, then state that its notification/policy text is not an outcome statistic.

15 marks - UAPA/NIA amendments in the security environment. State the qualified thesis: the 2019 amendments widened preventive/investigative reach to address evolving networks, but statutory power requires proportionate, reviewable use and prosecutorial follow-through. Analyse individual designation, Inspector-rank NIA investigation, DG-NIA approval for seizure/attachment, extraterritorial scheduled-offence jurisdiction and Special Courts; contrast designation, arrest, charge-sheet and conviction. Close with the federal role of State police and the rule-of-law safeguard.

15/20 marks - complexity, causes, nexus and eradication. Draw a short chain: ideology/grievance or external sponsorship -> recruitment -> finance/logistics/technology -> attack/propaganda -> fear and legitimacy loss. Explain why each link needs a distinct tool; add a limitation that overbroad coercion can create recruitment vulnerability. A verdict should prefer prevention and legitimate prosecution to a claim of "eradication" by force alone.

Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification bank

Claim	Named evidence/example	What it proves	Qualification
Terrorism can be state-enabled while operationally non-state.	Singh's proxy/deniability account; J&K route in topic 05.	Actor type and operational front must be analysed separately.	Attribute a current incident only to a dated competent-agency finding.
Counter-terrorism is a chain, not an agency list.	NIA Act, 2008; MAC/SMAC; State police; Special Courts.	Intelligence, investigation and prosecution have different mandates.	Intelligence lead is not admissible proof; NIA does not replace local police.
The legal framework changed after the book period.	UAPA and NIA amendments, 2019; BNS section 113 in force 1 July 2024.	A current answer can distinguish special and general penal routes.	BNS section 113 did not repeal UAPA; choice of statute is not proof of outcome.
PRAHAAR adds a policy architecture.	MHA's National Counter-Terrorism Policy and Strategy, 23 February 2026.	Its prevention, response, capacity, rights/rule-of-law, attenuating-conditions, international-alignment and recovery/resilience pillars give a current framework.	It is a policy/strategy, not a new arresting, investigating or intelligence agency.

Direct PYQ routes now owned in Core

- **2019 GS-III:** use the UAPA/NIA 15-mark spine; state a security rationale and a due-process qualification for every expanded power.
- **2021 GS-III:** use the complexity chain and link terror finance to topic 10, organised-crime logistics to topic 11 and digital radicalisation to topic 09 without confusing their objectives.
- **2025 GS-III:** use the 10-mark manifestation/measures spine; "recent" policy is a safer current example than an unverified attack claim.

13. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion:
advanced/02_Terrorism-and-Counter-Terror-Architecture.md.
- FACT: 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 1, 5 and 6 - the results chain, the actor-response matrix and the federal/institutional architecture.
- ANALYSIS: **Downstream/lateral topics in this folder:** Topic 05 develops J&K-specific proxy-war detail; topic 09 develops online radicalisation; topic 10 develops terror financing in full; topic 12 develops NIA/MAC/ NSG/NATGRID institutional mandates in full.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - PRAHAAR SEVEN ELEMENTS AND QUALIFIED COUNTER-TERROR ANSWER

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - PRAHAAR seven elements and qualified counter-terror answer

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · PRAHAAR seven elements · qualified counter-terror answer · Mechanism chain · Qualified use · Subject

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Mechanism chain: PRAHAAR policy - Policy-agency-outcome firewall Qualified use: Use the seven elements as a policy frame and finish with rule-of-law legitimacy.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Thesis: Terrorism in India is not one incident category but a set of political/ideological coercion pathways; a credible counter-terror answer matches prevention, response, investigation, prosecution, finance disruption and recovery to the pathway while preserving lawful process.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Read PRAHAAR seven elements and qualified counter-terror answer as a sequence: identify PRAHAAR policy, follow the named mechanism to its institutional response, and stop at the last verified status rather than assuming the next stage.

INTERNAL SECURITY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Terrorism analysis separates contested definition, ideological or strategic motive, recruitment and radicalisation, financing, logistics, attack cycle, prevention, investigation, prosecution and recovery.
- **Close distinction:** Designation is not conviction, prevention is not response, radicalisation is not automatically terrorism, intelligence lead is not admissible evidence, and financing investigation is not prosecution.
- **Mechanism / status / evidence limit:** Use UAPA, NIA, FATF and Indian institutions only with exact legal or institutional status; never invent incident, casualty, conviction, funding or disruption figures.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Terrorism definition?

A. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: A. Explanation: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q2. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Terrorism definition?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: B. Explanation: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q3. Which statement uses Terrorism definition without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

Answer: C. Explanation: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Terrorism definition?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: D. Explanation: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism?

A. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: A. Explanation: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are

not synonyms. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q6. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

Answer: B. Explanation: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q7. Which statement uses Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism without changing its institution, law or status?

A. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. B. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. C. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. D. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

Answer: C. Explanation: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism?

A. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.

Answer: D. Explanation: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies State-proxy boundary?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: A. Explanation: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q10. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of State-proxy boundary?

A. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. B. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: B. Explanation: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q11. Which statement uses State-proxy boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. C. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: C. Explanation: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about State-proxy boundary?

A. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. B. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. C. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: D. Explanation: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Manifestation categories?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q14. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Manifestation categories?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q15. Which statement uses Manifestation categories without changing its institution, law or status?

A. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. D. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Manifestation categories?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Funding architecture?

A. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. B. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: A. Explanation: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q18. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Funding architecture?

A. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q19. Which statement uses Funding architecture without changing its institution, law or status?

A. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: C. Explanation: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner,

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Funding architecture?

A. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. B. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. C. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. D. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

Answer: D. Explanation: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Counter-terror chain?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: A. Explanation: The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q22. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Counter-terror chain?

A. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. B. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. C. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. D. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.

Answer: B. Explanation: The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q23. Which statement uses Counter-terror chain without changing its institution, law or status?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Counter-terror chain?

A. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. D. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: D. Explanation: The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Post-26/11 build-out?

A. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. B. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: A. Explanation: After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q26. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Post-26/11 build-out?

A. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. B. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: B. Explanation: After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q27. Which statement uses Post-26/11 build-out without changing its institution, law or status?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: C. Explanation: After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Post-26/11 build-out?

A. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. D. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

Answer: D. Explanation: After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies NIA boundary?

A. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. B. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. C. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q30. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NIA boundary?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. D. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q31. Which statement uses NIA boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. D. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NIA boundary?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies MAC-SMAC boundary?

A. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. B. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: A. Explanation: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q34. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of MAC-SMAC boundary?

A. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. B. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: B. Explanation: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q35. Which statement uses MAC-SMAC boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

Answer: C. Explanation: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MAC-SMAC boundary?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. D. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.

Answer: D. Explanation: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies NATGRID boundary?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: A. Explanation: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q38. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NATGRID boundary?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

Answer: B. Explanation: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q39. Which statement uses NATGRID boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: C. Explanation: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NATGRID boundary?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: D. Explanation: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies NCTC federalism issue?

A. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

Answer: A. Explanation: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q42. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NCTC federalism issue?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. C. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. D. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

Answer: B. Explanation: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination

need did not automatically justify centralisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q43. Which statement uses NCTC federalism issue without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. D. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Answer: C. Explanation: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NCTC federalism issue?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies State-police primacy?

A. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: A. Explanation: Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q46. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of State-police primacy?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. D. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

Answer: B. Explanation: Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q47. Which statement uses State-police primacy without changing its institution, law or status?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Answer: C. Explanation: Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about State-police primacy?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. C. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. D. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Answer: D. Explanation: Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies UAPA 2019 designation?

A. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. B. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. C. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: A. Explanation: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q50. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of UAPA 2019 designation?

A. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. D. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Answer: B. Explanation: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q51. Which statement uses UAPA 2019 designation without changing its institution, law or status?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. C. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: C. Explanation: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about UAPA 2019 designation?

A. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. B. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. C. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. D. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

Answer: D. Explanation: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Designation-conviction firewall?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: A. Explanation: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. The other options change the threat

category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q54. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Designation-conviction firewall?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. C. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: B. Explanation: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q55. Which statement uses Designation-conviction firewall without changing its institution, law or status?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. C. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. D. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: C. Explanation: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Designation-conviction firewall?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

Answer: D. Explanation: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies NIA 2019 amendment?

A. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be

designated Special Courts. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q58. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NIA 2019 amendment?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. D. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q59. Which statement uses NIA 2019 amendment without changing its institution, law or status?

A. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. B. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. C. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. D. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NIA 2019 amendment?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies BNS-UAPA concurrency?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: A. Explanation: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q62. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of BNS-UAPA concurrency?

A. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. B. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: B. Explanation: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q63. Which statement uses BNS-UAPA concurrency without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. B. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. C. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. D. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about BNS-UAPA concurrency?

A. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. B. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. C. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. D. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Answer: D. Explanation: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies UAPA bail boundary?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: A. Explanation: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q66. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of UAPA bail boundary?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q67. Which statement uses UAPA bail boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. B. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. C. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: C. Explanation: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about UAPA bail boundary?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.

Answer: D. Explanation: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies TADA-POTA precedent?

A. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. B. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. C. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. D. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q70. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of TADA-POTA precedent?

A. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. B. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.

Answer: B. Explanation: TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q71. Which statement uses TADA-POTA precedent without changing its institution, law or status?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: C. Explanation: TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about TADA-POTA precedent?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: D. Explanation: TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies PRAHAAR policy?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: A. Explanation: PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q74. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of PRAHAAR policy?

A. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. B. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. C. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: B. Explanation: PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q75. Which statement uses PRAHAAR policy without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: C. Explanation: PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PRAHAAR policy?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: D. Explanation: PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Policy-agency-outcome firewall?

A. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. B. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. C. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: A. Explanation: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q78. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Policy-agency-outcome firewall?

A. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. B. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. C. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: B. Explanation: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q79. Which statement uses Policy-agency-outcome firewall without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: C. Explanation: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Policy-agency-outcome firewall?

A. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED TOPIC-SPECIFIC PYQ OWNERSHIP

The owner and audited GS-III ledgers route the 2019 UAPA/NIA amendment demand, the 2021 terrorism-complexity demand and the 2025 manifestation/counter-measures demand here. No objective key or unverified contemporary incident attribution is supplied.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III

Demand: UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment.

Status: Audited neutral rendering; Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words. The owner and OCR paper verify the routed demand.

Model solution: NIA boundary: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **NCTC federalism issue:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA 2019 designation:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Designation-conviction firewall:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **NIA 2019 amendment:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian

citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

UAPA bail boundary: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **TADA-POTA precedent:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: NIA boundary: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **NCTC federalism issue:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA 2019 designation:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Designation-conviction firewall:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **NIA 2019 amendment:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **TADA-POTA precedent:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: Audited neutral rendering; Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words. The owner and OCR paper verify the routed demand. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: NIA boundary: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **NCTC federalism issue:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA 2019 designation:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Designation-conviction firewall:** Individual designation, arrest,

charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **NIA 2019 amendment:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **TADA-POTA precedent:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III

Demand: Terrorism complexity, causes, linkages, nexus and measures for eradication.

Status: Audited neutral rendering; Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words.

Model solution: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Funding architecture:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Funding architecture:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and

specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: Terrorism complexity, causes, linkages, nexus and measures for eradication. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: Audited neutral rendering; Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Funding architecture:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 GS-III

Demand: "Terrorism is a global scourge. How has it manifested in India? Elaborate with contemporary examples. What are the counter measures adopted by the State? Explain."

Status: Verbatim owner-preserved question; Elaborate/Explain · 10 marks · 150 words.

Model solution: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Post-26/11 build-out:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **NIA boundary:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **MAC-SMAC boundary:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **PRAHAAR policy:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Post-26/11 build-out:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **NIA boundary:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **MAC-SMAC boundary:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **PRAHAAR policy:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: "Terrorism is a global scourge. How has it manifested in India? Elaborate with contemporary examples. What are the counter measures adopted by the State? Explain." **Named evidence/example:** Identify

the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

2. **Claim:** Status: Verbatim owner-preserved question; Elaborate/Explain · 10 marks · 150 words. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Post-26/11 build-out:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **NIA boundary:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **MAC-SMAC boundary:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **PRAHAAR policy:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism in India's internal-security discourse. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is

armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.
- Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.
- The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:**

Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories.

Named evidence/example: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'Distinguish terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism in India's internal-security discourse. Answer...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:**

Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories.

Named evidence/example: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Distinguish terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism in India's internal-security discourse. Answer...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the prevention-to-prosecution counter-terror chain and the institutions at each stage. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.
- The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.
- MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on 'Explain the prevention-to-prosecution counter-terror chain and the institutions at each...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Explain the prevention-to-prosecution counter-terror chain and the institutions at each...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Analyse the UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat

category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA 2019 amendment. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** TADA-POTA precedent. **Named evidence/example:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.
- The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.
- The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.
- Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.
- The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.
- UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
- TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.
- The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.
- The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.
- Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.
- The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.
- UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
- TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in

nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation.

Named evidence/example: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA 2019 amendment. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** TADA-POTA precedent. **Named evidence/example:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on 'Analyse the UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment. Answer in...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal

instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA 2019 amendment. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** TADA-POTA precedent. **Named evidence/example:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Named evidence/example: Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

7. **Claim:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation.

Named evidence/example: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA 2019 amendment. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** TADA-POTA precedent. **Named evidence/example:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Analyse the UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment. Answer in...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine India's cooperative-federal counter-terror architecture with reference to the NCTC controversy. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Post-26/11 build-out. **Named evidence/example:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.
- The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

- MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.
- The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Post-26/11 build-out. **Named evidence/example:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on 'Examine India's cooperative-federal counter-terror architecture with reference to the NCTC...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Post-26/11 build-out. **Named evidence/example:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat

category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Post-26/11 build-out. **Named evidence/example:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response,

evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Examine India's cooperative-federal counter-terror architecture with reference to the NCTC...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse terrorism's causes, linkages and finance-logistics nexus and suggest a calibrated response. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-proxy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Funding architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance

disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.
- A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.
- The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.
- Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.
- The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.
- UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
- PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.
- PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-proxy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Funding architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship,

extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary.

Named evidence/example: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on 'Analyse terrorism's causes, linkages and finance-logistics nexus and suggest a calibrated...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: State-proxy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories.

Named evidence/example: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Funding architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and

notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat

mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence.

Qualification: State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

7. **Claim:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-proxy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Funding architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy

implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Analyse terrorism's causes, linkages and finance-logistics nexus and suggest a calibrated...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically evaluate PRAHAAR as a policy framework for contemporary terrorism while preserving federalism and rights. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** BNS-UAPA concurrency. **Named evidence/example:** BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified

evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.
- MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.
- The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.
- The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.
- Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.
- BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.
- UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
- PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.
- PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing

competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** BNS-UAPA concurrency. **Named evidence/example:** BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on 'Critically evaluate PRAHAAR as a policy framework for contemporary terrorism while preserving...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing

competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** BNS-UAPA concurrency. **Named evidence/example:** BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

3. **Claim:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
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10. **Claim:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; 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Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response ->

outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Critically evaluate PRAHAAR as a policy framework for contemporary terrorism while preserving...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Internal Security | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III. **Core area:** The NCTC federalism critique; intelligence-operations- investigation-prosecution as a federal chain, not a central monopoly; designation versus prosecution after the 2019 UAPA amendment; the BNS-versus-UAPA forum-choice problem; terror financing disruption; the rights/accountability dimension of counter-terror law; PRAHAAR's design logic. **Grounded in:** Ashok Kumar Singh, *Challenges to Internal Security of India*, PDF pp. 13-22; 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 5-9; audited GS-III syllabus; MHA, *PRAHAAR* (23 February 2026); UAPA (Amendment) Act 2019, NIA (Amendment) Act 2019 and BNS 2023 as published in India Code. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor | **WRONG:** = boundary/trap. *Companion:* basic/02_Terrorism-and-Counter-Terror-Architecture.md.

1. Answer thesis and syllabus boundary

Thesis: ANALYSIS: India's post-26/11 counter-terror architecture repeatedly tried to centralise coordination (NCTC) but was constrained by the constitutional reality that policing is a State subject - the durable design that survived is federal-cooperative (NIA/MAC operating with, not over, State police), and PRAHAAR (2026) formalises this cooperative model rather than reopening the centralisation debate. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not cover LWE-specific or J&K-specific operational detail (topics 03 and 05) or terror financing mechanics in full (topic 10); it covers the general terrorism/counter-terror institutional and legal architecture.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: NCTC's federalism problem	FACT: Singh records the core objection precisely: "As per the constitutional provisions, law and order is a state subject. The powers conferred on the NCTC to search, arrest individuals and carry out independent investigations without involving the State Government is viewed as an infringement on the states' powers" (PDF p. 18).
ANALYSIS: Coordination vs. centralisation	Effective counter-terror architecture requires real-time coordination across agencies (a genuine need Singh documents) but not necessarily a single central body with independent arrest/investigation powers over States - MAC's information-sharing model versus NCTC's proposed operational powers illustrate this distinction.
FACT: State police's irreplaceable local role	FACT: Singh argues the "first person to reach the site of a terrorist attack would invariably be the local police," and that "preservation of evidence, securing witnesses, managing the media... are other dimensions... which can only be handled by the state police" (PDF p. 19) - a structural, not merely political, argument for State-police primacy in prevention, containment and initial investigation.
FACT: Four-function counter-terror chain	FACT: Singh's own structuring device: intelligence gathering -> training/operations -> investigation -> prosecution (PDF pp. 19-21), each with a distinct primary institutional owner.
ANALYSIS: Deniability vs. accountability	The proxy-actor logic (basic topic Section 3) that gives a sponsor state deniability is mirrored, on the domestic response side, by the need for transparent, accountable investigation and prosecution - using non-transparent or extra-legal methods to counter a deniable threat undermines the rule-of-law legitimacy the response depends on.
ANALYSIS: Designation vs. prosecution - two different legal logics	The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 lets the Central Government notify an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule. This is an executive, preventive/expressive act (it signals, restricts and enables listing-linked measures) with a statutory denotification/review route; prosecution is a judicial, punitive process requiring proof beyond reasonable doubt. ANALYSIS: The rights critique is precisely that the first carries reputational and practical consequences without the second's evidentiary threshold; the security case is that organisational bans are easily defeated by re-naming, which individual designation addresses. An advanced answer states both, and never treats designation as guilt.
ANALYSIS: Concurrent special and general law - the forum-choice problem	Since 1 July 2024, the same conduct can attract BNS Section 113 (terrorist act, general penal law, State-police-led) or UAPA (special law, with NIA's concurrent jurisdiction, stricter bail under Section 43D(5) and a sanction requirement under Section 45). ANALYSIS: BNS Section 113 places the choice with an officer not below SP rank. This is a genuinely new federal-design question: an executive officer's forum choice now determines which bail regime, sanction requirement and investigating agency apply - a discretion that did not exist before 2024 and that Mains answers on "counter-terror architecture" can legitimately flag as needing guidelines.

3. Detailed causal chain: from 26/11 to PRAHAAR

1. Coordination failure exposed: FACT: Singh notes that even though the

Mumbai Police and NSG were "applauded... for their operations during the 26/11 attacks," the response "brought to light serious flaws in coordination" (PDF pp. 14-15).

2. **Institutional proliferation:** FACT: Government created/strengthened NIA, NATGRID, MAC (revamped) and proposed NCTC, plus four new NSG hubs and a revamped Coastal Security Scheme (PDF pp. 15-16).

3. **NCTC's centralisation attempt and its federal check:** FACT: The NCTC concept, modelled on US/UK bodies and placed under IB's administrative control, was contested precisely because its proposed search/arrest powers bypassed State Government involvement (PDF p. 18) - the constitutional distribution of policing power acted as a real constraint on institutional design, not merely a political objection.

4. **Cooperative-federalism model consolidates:** ANALYSIS: NIA (a central investigating agency operating case-by-case, often at a State's request or Centre's direction) and MAC (an information-sharing platform, not an operational command) represent the model that endured, compared to NCTC's stalled, more centralised design.

5. **PRAHAAR formalises rather than restructures:** CURRENT: MHA's PRAHAAR (23 February 2026) explicitly works "through existing coordination" mechanisms - MAC, a Joint Task Force on Intelligence, NIA and State units - rather than creating a new central agency, consistent with the cooperative-federalism lesson of the NCTC episode.

6. **Threat-domain widening:** CURRENT: PRAHAAR explicitly recognises newer threat domains - cyberattacks by criminal/state actors, drone-based attacks, dark web/cryptocurrency misuse - alongside classical cross-border terrorism, linking this topic forward to topics 08-10.

7. **Legal architecture widened in parallel, in two directions:** ANALYSIS: the 2019 amendments widened *central* reach (individual designation under UAPA; NIA's extraterritorial jurisdiction and expanded schedule under the NIA Act), while BNS Section 113 (1 July 2024) widened *general* and therefore *State-police* reach. The architecture has thus become more centralised and more decentralised at the same time - which is why the post-2024 coordination question is no longer "who investigates?" but "under which statute, and on whose discretion?"

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- FACT: **NIA:** federal investigating agency with concurrent jurisdiction (NIA Act, 2008); operates on specific scheduled offences, at State request or Central direction - not a blanket substitute for State police.

- FACT: **MAC/SMAC:** an intelligence-sharing, not an operational-command, platform; State-level SMACs preserve State agency involvement.

- ANALYSIS: **NCTC:** conceived but not implemented in the form originally proposed, owing to the federalism objection; its underlying coordination need was substantially absorbed into MAC's expanded role and, later, PRAHAAR's framework - verify NCTC's precise current legal/operational status from a dated MHA source before making any claim about it.

- ANALYSIS: **The post-2019 legal layer (not in Singh's book):** UAPA's Fourth Schedule individual-designation power, Inspector-rank NIA investigation and DG-NIA-approved property attachment; NIA's extraterritorial jurisdiction and expanded schedule; and, from 1 July 2024, BNS Section

113. ANALYSIS: Each is a *statutory power*; none is evidence of throughput.

Cite conviction, attachment-confirmation or trial-completion data only from a dated NIA/MHA/National Crime Records Bureau publication.

- CURRENT: **PRAHAAR (2026):** the current apex policy document; its seven elements (prevention, response, aggregating capacities, human rights/rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, recovery/resilience) map onto Singh's four-function chain (Section 3 above) as follows: prevention/attenuating conditions -> intelligence and root-cause work; response/aggregating capacities -> operations; human rights/rule of law -> investigation and prosecution safeguards; international alignment -> cross-border cooperation (IR-owned diplomatic detail, internal-security-owned operational effect).

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- ANALYSIS: **UAPA's widening scope as a rights boundary case:** the 2012

amendment bringing economic offences (fund-raising, counterfeiting) within "terrorist act" expands prosecutorial reach but also widens the space in which due-process safeguards must operate - an explicit trade-off, not a costless expansion. ANALYSIS: The 2019 amendment sharpens the same trade-off: individual designation is an executive act with real consequences, and its safeguard is a review/denotification mechanism rather than a prior judicial finding.

- ANALYSIS: **Bail as the operative rights question, not detention length:**

under UAPA Section 43D(5) a court may not grant bail if, on the case diary/report, there are reasonable grounds to believe the accusation is prima facie true - a substantially higher bar than ordinary bail law. ANALYSIS: This is why "arrest under UAPA" and "conviction under UAPA" can diverge sharply in time and in number: the operative deprivation of liberty often occurs during trial, not after it. An advanced answer that identifies bail (not the length of the sentence) as the real proportionality question is making the argument examiners reward.

- ANALYSIS: **TADA/POTA's lapse as a legitimacy precedent:** both special laws

were allowed to lapse or were repealed following documented misuse concerns (Singh, PDF pp. 16-17) - a precedent Mains answers can cite when discussing the tension between stringent anti-terror powers and accountability.

- ANALYSIS: **NCTC as the clearest cooperative-federalism boundary case:** it

shows that even a genuinely felt coordination need (real-time, cross-agency intelligence-to-arrest capability) can be constitutionally and politically unworkable if it bypasses State policing powers - a reusable analytical point for any "should India centralise X" question in this folder (e.g., topic 12's coordination reform debate).

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: **Centralisation gains speed but risks federal and rights friction;**

cooperative models preserve federal balance but depend on State capacity and willingness to coordinate - neither is costless.

- ANALYSIS: ****Special anti-terror laws face a recurring misuse-vs.-necessity**

trade-off**, illustrated by TADA and POTA's histories; every expansion of investigative power (e.g., UAPA amendments) must be paired with a corresponding accountability safeguard to sustain legitimacy.

- ANALYSIS: **A "whole-of-society" framing (PRAHAAR) is aspirationally broad;**

its practical test is whether attenuating-conditions work (community engagement, counter-radicalisation) receives resources comparable to the response/aggregating-capacities elements, which are easier to fund and measure.

- WRONG: **PRAHAAR is not a new investigating or intelligence agency** - do

not describe it as such in a Mains answer; it is a policy and coordination framework operating through existing institutions.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: NCTC's core federalism objection: its proposed search/arrest powers

over any part of the country, without mandatory State Government involvement, were viewed as infringing States' policing powers; FACT: a second objection in the same passage was institutional - granting arrest powers to an intelligence body breaches the principle that intelligence agencies do not arrest.

- FACT: Singh's four-function counter-terror chain: intelligence gathering,

training/operations, investigation, prosecution.

- FACT: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits designation of **individuals**

as terrorists (Fourth Schedule) - an executive notification with a statutory review route, not a judicial finding of guilt.

- FACT: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extended NIA's jurisdiction to scheduled

offences committed **outside India** affecting Indian citizens or Indian interests, and allowed Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

- FACT: BNS Section 113 (in force 1 July 2024) brings "terrorist act" into

general penal law; an officer not below SP rank decides whether to proceed under BNS or UAPA.

- **CURRENT:** PRAHAAR (23 February 2026) is organised around seven elements and explicitly recognises cyberattacks, drone-based attacks and dark web/cryptocurrency misuse as contemporary threat domains.
- **FACT:** TADA (1985-1995) and POTA (2002-2004) were both special anti-terror laws that lapsed/were repealed amid misuse concerns, prior to the current UAPA-centred framework.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- **WRONG:** NCTC was fully implemented as originally proposed and now functions as India's apex counter-terror body. -> The concept faced sustained federalism-based criticism and was not implemented as originally conceived; MAC and, later, PRAHAAR absorbed much of its coordination intent through a cooperative-federalism design instead.
- **WRONG:** PRAHAAR replaces NIA, MAC and State police with a new central body. -> PRAHAAR explicitly works through existing institutions; it is a policy and strategy framework, not a new operational agency.
- **WRONG:** Designation of an individual under UAPA and conviction for a terrorist act are the same legal event. -> Designation is an executive Fourth-Schedule notification; conviction requires a Special Court trial to the criminal standard of proof. Conflating them is the single most common rights-analysis error on this topic.
- **WRONG:** BNS Section 113 replaced or repealed UAPA. -> Both operate concurrently; the practical question the 2024 codes created is which of the two an SP-rank officer elects to invoke, and with what consequences for bail, sanction and investigating agency.
- **WRONG:** Expanding UAPA's scope carries no legitimacy cost. -> Every expansion of investigative/prosecutorial reach (e.g., 2012 economic-offence inclusion, 2019 individual designation) requires a corresponding accountability safeguard to avoid the misuse pattern that ended TADA and POTA.

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor note

- **CURRENT:** MHA's **PRAHAAR** (23 February 2026) is the current apex counter-terrorism policy document; verify any further operational detail (budget, specific new mechanisms, NCTC's precise present-day status) from the MHA Annual Report 2024-25 or a subsequent official release before citing it - this topic does not assume any claim not confirmed by a dated official source.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: India's counter-terror architecture is a cooperative-federalism design, not a centralised one - a lesson learned directly from the NCTC controversy - and PRAHAAR (2026) is best understood as the current policy layer that coordinates this existing architecture across a widened set of threat domains, rather than a new institution in its own right.

1. **State the definitional and categorical foundation** (basic topic Sections 1-2).
2. **Trace the post-26/11 institutional build-out** and the specific federalism objection that stalled NCTC.
3. ****Show why the surviving model (NIA + MAC + State police) is cooperative, not centralised****, using Singh's State-police-primacy argument.
4. **Introduce PRAHAAR (2026)** as the current coordinating policy layer, naming its seven elements and its explicit newer threat domains.
5. **Acknowledge the rights/accountability trade-off** in any specific legal tool cited (UAPA, special courts), using the TADA/POTA precedent.
6. ****Close by relating the architecture back to the master-framework results chain**** - threat, actor, response, federal constraint, calibrated way forward.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Which constitutional feature underlay the primary objection to the National Counter Terrorism Centre (NCTC) as originally proposed?
- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Under which Schedule of the UAPA may the Central Government designate an individual as a terrorist, and is such designation a judicial or an executive act?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "India's counter-terror institutional architecture is cooperative-federal, not centralised, by constitutional necessity." Discuss with reference to the NCTC episode.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "The 2019 amendment shifted UAPA's centre of gravity from organisations to individuals." Examine the security rationale and the due-process implications.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Critically examine PRAHAAR (2026) as India's first comprehensive national counter-terrorism policy, distinguishing its policy-coordination role from an operational agency's role.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion:
basic/02_Terrorism-and-Counter-Terror-Architecture.md.
- FACT: 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 6 and 9 - the federal architecture and Mains answer spine.
- FACT: 12_Security-Forces-Intelligence-Coordination-and-Rights (basic and advanced) - full institutional mandates for NIA, MAC, IB, NATGRID and CAPFs.
- ANALYSIS: **Lateral topics in this folder:** Topic 05 for J&K-specific proxy-war detail; topic 09 for online radicalisation; topic 10 for terror financing disruption in full.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture: TERRORISM DEFINITIONS, ACTORS AND MANIFESTATIONS

1. **Terrorism definition:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.
2. **Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.
3. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.
4. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.
5. **Funding architecture:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.
6. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.
7. **Post-26/11 build-out:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

8. **NIA boundary:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.
9. **MAC-SMAC boundary:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.
10. **NATGRID boundary:** NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.
11. **NCTC federalism issue:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.
12. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.
13. **UAPA 2019 designation:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.
14. **Designation-conviction firewall:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.
15. **NIA 2019 amendment:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.
16. **BNS-UAPA concurrency:** BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.
17. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
18. **TADA-POTA precedent:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.
19. **PRAHAAR policy:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.
20. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture: INSTITUTIONS, SPECIAL LAWS AND FEDERAL BOUNDARIES

- Do not use terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism as synonyms.
- Do not treat a proxy organisation as wholly detached from possible state support.
- Do not assert present attribution from book-period descriptions.
- Do not merge NIA, MAC, NATGRID, NCTC and NSG.
- Do not describe intelligence sharing as admissible proof.
- Do not describe NIA as a replacement for State police.
- Do not call individual designation a conviction.
- Do not say BNS section 113 repealed UAPA.
- Do not convert statutory reach into investigative throughput.
- Do not omit bail and review safeguards from a legal-power answer.
- Do not describe PRAHAAR as a new operational agency.
- Do not expose tactical details, identities or unverified incident claims.

Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture: COUNTER-TERROR CHAIN AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE

DEFINE TERRORISM AND DISTINGUISH INSURGENCY NAXALISM
-> CLASSIFY MANIFESTATION ACTOR PROXY AND ATTRIBUTION
-> TRACE FUNDING LOGISTICS AND VULNERABILITY WITHOUT TACTICAL DETAIL
-> MAP PREVENTION RESPONSE INVESTIGATION PROSECUTION RECOVERY
-> SEPARATE NIA MAC SMAC NATGRID NCTC AND STATE POLICE
-> STATE UAPA DESIGNATION NIA JURISDICTION BNS ROUTE AND BAIL
-> APPLY PRAHAAR'S SEVEN ELEMENTS
-> CONCLUDE WITH FEDERAL COOPERATION RULE OF LAW AND VERIFIED STATUS

Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture: PRAHAAR, RIGHTS AND EVIDENCE-RUNG FIREWALL

PRAHAAR is retained as MHA's 23 February 2026 policy and strategy with seven elements. Its release does not create a new agency or prove prevention, conviction, disruption or incident-reduction outcomes.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Terrorism concept map

PURPOSE -> political / religious / ideological coercion
METHOD -> planned, organised, systematic violence
ACTOR -> state, proxy, network or individual
OUTCOME SOUGHT -> fear, compliance, legitimacy erosion

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Three-category firewall

TERRORISM -> broad coercive violence category
INSURGENCY -> armed rebellion with claimed social support
NAXALISM -> Maoist guerrilla route to state power
RULE -> overlap does not erase distinct objectives

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Manifestation matrix

HINTERLAND MODULES | J&K PROXY VIOLENCE
NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY | LEFT-WING EXTREMISM
FOR EACH -> actor + vulnerability + finance + response
CURRENT EXAMPLE -> use dated official status only

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Funding disruption chain

SOURCE -> sponsor / extortion / contraband / charity
TRANSFER -> hawala / cash / counterfeit / digital channel
USE -> recruitment / logistics / propaganda
RESPONSE -> intelligence + financial investigation + prosecution

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Counter-terror function chain

PREVENTION / INTELLIGENCE
-> CONTAINMENT / SPECIALISED RESPONSE
-> INVESTIGATION
-> PROSECUTION
-> RECOVERY / RESILIENCE

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Post-26/11 institution map

NIA -> scheduled-offence investigation
MAC / SMAC -> intelligence sharing
NATGRID -> data-linkage architecture
NCTC -> contested centralisation proposal
NSG HUBS -> specialised crisis response

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Federal response architecture

STATE POLICE -> first response, scene, evidence, local order
CENTRAL AGENCIES -> scheduled investigation / intelligence support
SPECIAL COURTS -> trial
RULE -> cooperation without institutional substitution

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: NCTC decision tree

NEED -> real-time national coordination
PROPOSED POWER -> search / arrest / investigation
OBJECTION -> State police competence + intelligence-arrest separation
DURABLE MODEL -> coordinated platforms and case-based investigation

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: UAPA designation ladder

CENTRAL NOTIFICATION -> FOURTH SCHEDULE DESIGNATION
APPLICATION / REVIEW -> STATUTORY ROUTE
ARREST / CHARGE-SHEET -> SEPARATE CRIMINAL PROCESS
CONVICTION -> JUDICIAL FINDING AFTER TRIAL

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: NIA amendment map

OUTSIDE INDIA -> Indian citizen / interest nexus
EXPANDED SCHEDULE -> specified additional offences
SPECIAL COURTS -> Sessions Courts may be designated
RULE -> jurisdictional power is not a case outcome
MUST REMEMBER: Terrorism analysis separates contested definition, ideological or...
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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: BNS-UAPA forum choice

BNS 113 -> general penal law
UAPA -> special anti-terror law
SP-RANK DECISION -> route selected
CONSEQUENCE -> agency, bail and sanction framework differ
RULE -> both remain in force
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Designation is not conviction, prevention is not response,...
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Designation is not conviction, prevention is not response,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: PRAHAAR policy rail

PREVENT -> RESPOND -> AGGREGATE CAPACITIES
RIGHTS / RULE OF LAW -> ATTENUATE CONDITIONS
ALIGN INTERNATIONALLY -> RECOVER / BUILD RESILIENCE
QUALIFY -> policy, not agency; framework, not outcome
EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: Use UAPA, NIA, FATF and Indian...
EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: Use UAPA, NIA, FATF and Indian...